Reviewer 1: Anonymous

In the manuscript by Srivastava GK et al., the authors presented some evidences in vitro on the role of YIGSR sequence contained elastin like recombinamer for sustaining retinal pigment epithelium. Although some of the findings presented in the study are of some interest and novel, the conclusions and the discussion are completely out of focus and are not exactly sustained by the results. My main comments are following:

1) Authors mention about mesenchymal switching but none of the mesenchymal markers were evaluated. RPE cells sustaining the RPE characteristics on the surface of ELR-YIGSR has been mentioned several times but there is no direct comparison demonstrated. A direct comparison (transcript or protein) should be performed for control RPE cells versus RPE cells on ELR-YIGSR and polystyrene.

2) The authors claim in line 284 and figure 1 that there was a significant difference in the number of cells at 4 hrs. However, the similar difference is not reflected in figure 2 at 4 hrs, and significance was observed only for 24 and 72 hrs. This needs to be explained.

3) In line 321 and fig 3, authors claim more cell death for the surface of ELR-YIGSR in comparison to polystyrene. However, there are no direct comparison/stat is demonstrated to support the statement.

4) Authors need to demonstrate the stat for the growth rate (doubling time) within and between the groups.

5) The manuscript would be greatly improved by revision of the figures. This should include providing higher resolution graphs and photographs. Figures are of very poor quality. The labels of the axes are barely readable and cells in the bright field are not visible. Given the importance of figure 5, the authors should provide a separate (protein of interest and nucleus) and merged pictures for Fig 5 A, B and C. Using one negative control is not appropriate. Either the authors should provide all the negative controls or describe this information only in the results.

6) The references are pooled together and are not statement-specific. For example, paragraph 1 of the introduction section.

7) Please avoid the syntax errors and spelling mistakes (i.e. line 220, 509, 513, 516, etc).